

IT SUPPORT STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

Phase 08: Documentation

Professional IT Operations & Service Desk Manual

Document Control	Value
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Status	Approved Template
Owner	IT Support Team
Classification	Internal Use
Review Cycle	Annual or after a material process change
Applies To	IT Support / Service Desk / IT Operations

1. Document Purpose

This manual establishes standardized procedures for recurring IT support activities. Its purpose is to ensure that support work is performed consistently, securely, traceably, and with an appropriate level of documentation.

2. Document Scope

The procedures cover service-desk intake, incident handling, troubleshooting, access and permissions, software installation, remote support, hardware support, escalation, documentation, and ticket closure. Organization-specific tools, names, addresses, credentials, and production values must be inserted only through approved controlled documentation.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Primary Responsibilities
End User	Report issues accurately, provide relevant information, follow approved instructions, and validate the resolution.
Service Desk / IT Support	Receive, classify, troubleshoot, document, resolve, or escalate support requests.
IT Administrator	Handle privileged administration, infrastructure changes, advanced troubleshooting, and approved escalations.
IT Manager	Approve major changes, review escalations, monitor service quality, and maintain governance.

Asset/Procurement Team	Maintain asset ownership, acquisition, replacement, and lifecycle records where applicable.
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4. General Support Principles

- Verify the requester and authorization before performing account, access, or sensitive actions.
- Follow least privilege and make the smallest approved change necessary.
- Protect credentials, authentication codes, private keys, personal information, and confidential business data.
- Inspect and diagnose before changing configuration.
- Use approved tools, software sources, and administrative procedures.
- Document important observations, actions, verification results, and escalation decisions.
- Validate the resolution before closing a ticket.

5. Priority and Impact Guidance

Priority	Typical Impact	Target Handling
Critical	Widespread outage, major business service unavailable, or serious security/data impact.	Immediate triage and escalation according to organizational incident policy.
High	Major user/group impact or important business function unavailable.	Prompt investigation and escalation when required.
Medium	Individual or limited-team issues with a workaround or moderate business impact.	Standard queue handling documented troubleshooting.
Low	Minor issues, request, information, or non-urgent improvement.	Handle through normal service-desk workflow.

6. SOP-01: Incident Intake and Ticket Creation

Purpose

Ensure every support issue is captured accurately and routed to the appropriate support queue.

Procedure

1. Receive the request through an approved support channel.
2. Confirm the requester's identity when the request involves account, access, or sensitive information.
3. Record the user's department, affected service/device, problem description, business impact, and relevant time information.
4. Determine whether the request is an incident, service request, access request, or another support category.
5. Assign an appropriate priority based on impact and urgency.
6. Record relevant troubleshooting already attempted by the user.
7. Assign the ticket to the appropriate support queue or technician.

8. Acknowledge the request and communicate the next expected action.

Required Ticket Fields

- Ticket ID
- Date/time received
- Requester
- Department
- Contact method
- Affected device/service
- Issue summary
- Business impact
- Priority
- Category
- Assigned technician/queue
- Current status

Completion Criteria

The ticket is considered correctly created when the issue is understandable to another technician, the impact and priority are recorded, and the ticket is assigned to an appropriate queue.

7. SOP-02: Basic IT Troubleshooting

Purpose

Provide a repeatable first line troubleshooting method that minimizes disruption and creates a clear audit trail.

Procedure

1. Confirm the reported symptoms and business impact.
2. Ask when the issue started and whether it is intermittent or persistent.
3. Determine whether the issue affects one user, multiple users, one device, or multiple devices.
4. Identify recent changes such as updates, installations, configuration changes, or hardware movement.
5. Check obvious physical, connectivity, application, and system conditions.
6. Collect only the evidence necessary to diagnose the issue.
7. Form a reasonable troubleshooting hypothesis.
8. Apply the least disruptive approved corrective action.
9. Retest the affected functionality.
10. Document the result and either resolve or escalate the ticket.

Troubleshooting Record

Item	Record
Symptom	What the user observes
Scope	Who/what is affected
Recent Change	Relevant recent change or event
Checks Performed	Commands, settings, tests, or observations
Finding	Evidence-based diagnosis
Action	Corrective action performed
Verification	How the result was confirmed

8. SOP-03: Software Installation and Configuration

Purpose

Install approved software consistently while maintaining compatibility, licensing, security, and documentation requirements.

Procedure

1. Confirm that the software is approved for business use.
2. Confirm the user's business requirement and required license.
3. Verify operating-system and hardware compatibility.
4. Obtain the installer from an approved source.
5. Check available storage and required administrative permissions.
6. Install using the organization's standard configuration.
7. Apply required updates and security settings.
8. Launch the software and perform a basic functional test.
9. Document the software name, version, device, and relevant configuration.

Do Not

- Install unauthorized or pirated software.
- Use unknown download sources.
- Disable security controls solely to complete an installation.
- Store license keys or credentials in ordinary support tickets.

9. SOP-04: Account Access and Permissions

Purpose

Provide controlled access to systems and resources according to business need and least-privilege principles.

Procedure

1. Verify the user's identity and authorization.
2. Confirm the exact system, application, folder, or resource requested.
3. Confirm the business justification and required approval.
4. Determine the minimum access level required.
5. Apply the approved role, group, or permission.
6. Verify effective access without exposing confidential information.
7. Record the change, approval, and verification in the ticket.

Access Controls

- Never grant broad permissions when narrower permissions satisfy the requirement.
- Do not share administrative credentials.
- Do not bypass approval requirements.
- Remove temporary access when its approved period ends.

10.SOP-05: Remote Support

Purpose

Provide safe and documented remote assistance while protecting user privacy and system security.

Procedure

1. Confirm the support request and authorization for remote access.
2. Use only the approved remote-support tool or SSH method.
3. Confirm the correct target device before connecting.
4. Explain the actions that will be performed.
5. Avoid opening unrelated confidential files or collecting unnecessary data.
6. Perform the approved troubleshooting actions.
7. Verify the affected functionality with the user.
8. Disconnect the remote session when support is complete.
9. Document the session and outcome.

Remote Support Security

- Never request a user to disclose a password when the approved process provides another method.
- Never transfer sensitive files unless specifically authorized and required.
- Use secure protocols such as SSH/SCP/SFTP where applicable.
- Do not leave remote sessions active after support is complete.

11.SOP-06: Hardware Support and Asset Handling

Purpose

Standardize basic workstation and peripheral troubleshooting while maintaining accurate asset records.

Procedure

1. Confirm the affected asset and asset identifier.
2. Check power, cables, ports, displays, and approved peripheral connections.
3. Check for obvious physical damage.
4. Test the affected component using approved diagnostics where available.
5. Use a known-good component for controlled comparison when appropriate.
6. If hardware replacement is required, follow the asset and procurement process.
7. Update the asset register when ownership, location, or status changes.
8. Document the resolution or escalation.

12. SOP-07: Network and Connectivity Troubleshooting

Purpose

Provide a structured method for diagnosing common endpoint connectivity issues before escalation to network infrastructure support.

Procedure

1. Determine whether the problem affects one endpoint or multiple users.
2. Check physical Ethernet or approved wireless connectivity.

- 3. Review the endpoint's network configuration.
- 4. Test connectivity to the local gateway where appropriate.
- 5. Test an approved internal or external destination.
- 6. Check whether DNS resolution is functioning when relevant.
- 7. Restart the network connection only when appropriate.
- 8. Document observations and escalate infrastructure problems with evidence.

13.SOP-08: Remote Service and Linux Support

Purpose

Provide a safe reference for common Linux service-support activities using systemd and standard command-line diagnostics.

Procedure

- 1. Identify the actual service name before running service-specific commands.
- 2. Check service status with systemctl status.
- 3. Review recent service-specific logs with journalctl.
- 4. Determine whether the service is active, failed, stopped, or otherwise unavailable.
- 5. Restart only an authorized non-critical service when appropriate.
- 6. Verify service status after remediation.
- 7. Document the observed state, action, and verification result.

Example Commands

Purpose	Example
List running services	systemctl list-units --type=service --state=running
Check service	systemctl status <actual-service-name> --no-pager
Review logs	journalctl -u <actual-service-name> -n 20 --no-pager
Restart authorized service	sudo systemctl restart <actual-service-name>

Replace placeholders with the real authorized service name. Do not literally type angle-bracket placeholders as commands.

14. SOP-09: Security and Malware Incident Escalation

Purpose

Provide first-line guidance for suspected malware, phishing, account compromise, or other security-related events without destroying evidence.

Procedure

- 1. Treat the report as potentially security sensitive.
- 2. Record the observed symptoms and time without altering evidence unnecessarily.
- 3. Do not open suspicious files or links solely for investigation unless authorized.
- 4. Disconnect or isolate the affected device only according to approved incident-response procedures.

5. Escalate immediately to the designated security/IT administration team when required.
6. Preserve relevant logs, screenshots, filenames, and ticket information according to policy.
7. Document all actions and handoffs.

Important Restriction

First-line support should not attempt destructive malware removal or evidence alteration unless explicitly authorized by the organization's incident-response procedure.

15.SOP-10: Ticket Resolution and Closure

Purpose

Ensure incidents are closed only after the resolution has been verified and the support record is complete.

Closure Procedure

1. Confirm that the reported symptom has been resolved.
2. Perform an appropriate verification test.
3. Confirm with the user when user validation is required.
4. Document the root cause or most likely cause when known.
5. Document the corrective action.
6. Record any follow-up recommendation.
7. Review attachments and screenshots for unnecessary sensitive information.
8. Update the ticket status to Resolved/Closed according to policy.

Closure Checklist

Check	Required Result
Problem documented	Yes
Investigation documented	Yes
Resolution documented	Yes
Verification completed	Yes
User communication recorded	Yes when applicable
Sensitive information reviewed	Yes
Escalation recorded if applicable	Yes
Final status updated	Yes

16.Escalation Matrix

Situation	Escalate To	Examples
Privileged administration required	IT Administrator	System/service configuration, privileged account changes
Network infrastructure issue	Network/Infrastructure Team	Switch, router, firewall, widespread connectivity
Security incident	Security/IT Administration	Malware, phishing, suspected compromise
Data-loss or recovery issue	IT Administration / Data Owner	Deleted or inaccessible critical business data
Widespread outage	IT Manager / Infrastructure	Multiple departments or critical

		service unavailable
Hardware replacement	IT Asset/Procurement	Failed device requiring replacement

17. Evidence and Documentation Standards

- Use screenshots and logs only when they support diagnosis or verification.
- Sanitize usernames, hostnames, IP addresses, tokens, credentials, and other sensitive details when documentation does not require them.
- Use clear filenames and retain evidence in the approved ticket or documentation repository.
- Record commands and results accurately; do not fabricate system output.
- Document the exact action performed and the verification result.

18. Quality Assurance Checklist

- Procedure followed in the correct order.
- Authorization confirmed where required.
- Least-privilege approach used.
- No unnecessary sensitive information collected.
- Corrective action documented.
- Resolution independently understandable to another technician.
- User impact and final status recorded.

19. Document Maintenance

The IT Support Team should review this manual at least annually and whenever there is a significant change to support processes, technology, security requirements, escalation paths, or organizational responsibilities.

20. Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Owner
1.0	2026-08-10	Initial professional Phase 07 SOP manual.	IT Support Team